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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Bill would ban Native mascots

House passes legislation that could affect scores of schools

By **Jeremy Gorner**
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Following a wave of schools and professional sports teams over the last 20 years scaling back usage of Native American-themed names, imagery, mascots and logos, the Democrat-led Illinois House has advanced legislation that aims to place a statewide ban on such usage from elementary through high schools. The legislation has the potential to affect

scores of schools across Illinois, though that is still a small percentage of the thousands of schools in the state and the bill doesn't carry any penalties if schools ignore the measure. Still, the bill calls for banning schools from using Native American names, logos or mascots that include federally recognized tribes, historical Native American people or tribal groups. It also calls for prohibiting terms such as Redskins, Braves, Chiefs, Chieftains, Tribe and Indians from being used and barring depictions of feathered headdresses, tomahawks, arrowheads or spears, arrows or other weapons "if in combination with a feather or feathers."

If the bill were to become law, the measure would allow schools to continue using uniforms or materials with the names, logos or mascots until Sept. 1, 2030, if those schools devise a plan to adopt a new team name by July 1, 2026. Democratic state Rep. Maurice West of Rockford, the bill's main sponsor, said the 2030 deadline gives schools time to change logos on jerseys and on stadium or gymnasium marquees, while Republican lawmakers who opposed the legislation said it would be costly. In addition, schools under the legislation may continue using

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CHICAGO CITY COUNCIL

Deal for Reed's family nixed

Committee blocks \$1.25M settlement, likely costing millions more in legal fees

By **Jake Sheridan**
Chicago Tribune

Aldermen voted down a \$1.25 million settlement Friday for the family of Dexter Reed, the man shot and killed by police in a Humboldt Park gunfight last year. The deal for the family of the man who shot at police first and wounded an officer during a botched traffic stop sparked fierce debate before aldermen blocked it in a 12-to-15 Finance Committee vote. Proponents of the settlement argued it was sure to save the city millions by avoiding expensive legal costs, but opponents asserted that it would send a dangerous message. City attorney Caroline Fronczak told aldermen the city would likely pay around \$5 million in legal fees to fight the case, plus as much as \$3 million to \$5 million if the city lost in court. "It sounds like there is no way that we end up paying less than what's in front of us should we take this to trial," said Ald. Daniel La Spata, 1st. "That's correct," Fronczak replied. But the likely higher cost to fight the lawsuit was ultimately a price aldermen were willing to pay — including Johnson's handpicked Finance Chair, Ald. Pat Dowell, 3rd, who cast a critical "no" vote in the tight decision. Aldermen typically approve the settlements recommended by the mayor-controlled Law Department as a way to save

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EMIL JONES III TRIAL

‘I want to see u,’ says 2 a.m. text

State senator sent ex-intern late-night messages, money for strip club, jurors hear

By **Jason Meisner**
Chicago Tribune

Prosecutors in the bribery trial of state Sen. Emil Jones III presented evidence Friday showing Jones took a former intern to an expensive steak dinner, gave him money for a strip club and sent late-night texts asking to get together, all shortly before pushing for him to be hired by an executive for a red-light camera company. "I want to see u," Jones texted Christopher Katz at about 2 a.m. on July 7, 2019, according to one string of messages shown to the jury. Katz, then 23, had partied with Jones earlier in the night and twice asked the senator to send him cash, which evidence showed he did. Katz also invited Jones to the strip club, Sky11 in Harvey, but Jones did not agree to go. Hours later, shortly after 5 a.m., Jones sent Katz another message, saying, "Yo Wyo," or "What you on?" "Sleep," Katz replied. "Naw u up?" Jones asked.

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Remembering ‘boundless love’

Josephine Beauchane Corsello and D'Artagnan Corsello cry during the funeral for their three children, brothers Xander Harland Corsello, 2, Kayden Virgil and Jayden Dante, both 1, who died as a result of a house fire in Carpentersville last month. The funeral was held at Fox Valley Baptist Church in East Dundee on Friday. The community rallied around the family and helped raise the money for the services and burials through the nonprofit Taste the Love, based in West Dundee. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

“I really like (debate) because we get to see different perspectives and learn about Hispanic or global issues. It’s also great to learn how to express yourself and receive feedback from others — to learn from each other.” — Wendy DePaz, who moved to Chicago from Mexico three years ago

A team that’s right as reign

Back of the Yards debaters win Spanish national title

By **Nell Salzman**
Chicago Tribune

Ángel Tierrablanca and Wendy DePaz stood at the front of a jubilant group parading down the halls Friday morning at Back of the Yards College Preparatory High School wearing orange shirts and blaring Queen's victory anthem "We Are the Champions." Last weekend, the two became the first-ever high school debaters in Chicago to win the Spanish-language title in the Urban Debate National Championship. Amanti Washington and Kate'lynn Shaw of Kenwood Academy won the English national championship. The new Spanish debate program — a chapter of Debate en Español started in October at Back of the Yards College Prep — underscores the school's commitment to supporting dual language amid increased reticence towards bilingualism, made even harder by local budget constraints. It was the first time a Spanish-language division was included at the national competition,



Wendy DePaz, 17, left, and Ángel Tierrablanca, 16, hold their trophies as fellow students and faculty line the hallways at Back of the Yards College Prep in Chicago on Friday to celebrate the team's Spanish-language national debate title. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

hosted at Emory University in Atlanta. DePaz moved to Chicago from Mexico three years ago, she said, and wanted to find an extracurricular program in Spanish. "Joining this one allowed me to express myself without being afraid of what others might think," she said. Mary Carmen Moreno, the school's vice

Turn to Debate, Page 6

Italian beef for breakfast?

Trying to find footing, Portillo's takes a Chicago-themed morning menu for a test run, including a chocolate cake iced coffee based on its famous milkshake. **Business**

China hits back with tariffs

China said Friday that it was raising its tariffs on U.S. goods to 125%, retaliating for the third time in the escalating trade war between the superpowers. **Nation & World**

Bears' Allen ready to win now

Bears defensive coordinator Dennis Allen will have to be patient to install his system and rearrange pieces to his liking. But his vision is already heard. **Chicago Sports**

